

0:0:0.0 --> 0:0:4.370

Interviewer - GA

There we go. OK. So I was hoping we could start by you just sharing.

0:0:5.290 --> 0:0:7.760

Interviewer - GA

How long you've been a first responder?

0:0:9.710 --> 0:0:17.220

FR02

Ohh, let's see. I I've been working as a first responder since I graduated high school in [EARLY 2000]. So.

0:0:18.470 --> 0:0:18.900

Interviewer - GA

OK.

0:0:18.190 --> 0:0:19.490

FR02

Almost 20 years.

0:0:20.900 --> 0:0:24.390

Interviewer - GA

Wow, OK. And has your role evolved over time?

0:0:25.470 --> 0:0:34.660

FR02

Yes. So the my first, I first started out as a volunteer, I knew this was the career I thought I wanted to be in. And then from there I've progressed from.

0:0:36.410 --> 0:0:42.160

FR02

The base level of firefighter EMT becoming a paramedic to become a full time firefighter paramedic.

0:0:42.760 --> 0:0:48.290

FR02

Ohh, I've been a supervisor at both the Volunteer Department and the full time department I was with.

0:0:49.780 --> 0:0:56.790

FR02

The first level supervisor, Lieutenant, is in charge of like a crew or a truck. And then here recently in the past few years, I've been.

0:0:58.280 --> 0:1:0.220

FR02

Filling in for the shift commander.

0:1:0.910 --> 0:1:1.650

FR02

As a.

0:1:2.660 --> 0:1:11.930

FR02

As the Battalion Chief when the battalion chiefs off, so I fill in in that role occasionally and I'm responsible for the 20 some people that are working every shift.

0:1:13.100 --> 0:1:15.980

Interviewer - GA

Wow, so it's been, it's been quite the evolution that over time.

0:1:16.400 --> 0:1:21.480

FR02

Yeah, yeah, I've I followed the linear path. That is is out there so far.

0:1:23.310 --> 0:1:26.820

Interviewer - GA

And when you first started, or even up until now, had you heard of the some of the occupational stress

0:1:32.430 --> 0:1:34.860

Interviewer - GA

Uh, problems in the profession?

0:1:35.720 --> 0:1:45.950

FR02

So [ONE OF MY PARENT WAS A CAREER FIREFIGHTER FOR OVER A DECADE] and then had to leave the fire service because of an injury.

0:1:48.40 --> 0:1:52.800

FR02

So I was exposed to some of that a lot early on, especially when he got injured.

0:1:53.440 --> 0:2:9.530

FR02

Ohh and then as as time progressed you know I I just think I remember my first it's a critical incident, stress debriefing or management session where a group of us met and and discussed a call that we've been on that was affecting some other members pretty, pretty significantly. So from early on, I've been a part of some of it and I've been exposed to different things here and there in different ways.

0:2:19.740 --> 0:2:25.0

Interviewer - GA

How would you? How would you define occupational stress? What does that mean to you?

0:2:27.250 --> 0:2:34.580

FR02

Ah, I guess it would be any stress that that comes about due to the the nature of your job.

0:2:36.730 --> 0:2:41.130

FR02

Not not everyday life stress, but again specific to the nature of whatever your job is.

0:2:43.780 --> 0:2:50.450

Interviewer - GA

In your role, is that something that had those stressors changed as your role has changed?

0:2:51.210 --> 0:2:51.880

FR02

Absolutely. 100%.

0:2:53.100 --> 0:2:56.110

Interviewer - GA

And in in what way do you mind describing that?

0:2:56.500 --> 0:3:2.560

FR02

I guess I as a base level firefighter and EMT, you you worry the most about yourself.

0:3:3.650 --> 0:3:21.250

FR02

So you're worried about yourself, and then the people that you're caring about. As a firefighter, you want to make sure that you're your stress level involves a majority of making sure that you're capable of the tasks that you're set for thing. And you understand the task that you're asked to do. It's very task based and very.

0:3:22.430 --> 0:3:35.210

FR02

Decision based, especially in the EMS proportion of things to make sure that you are following the right guidelines and you're asking the right questions and you're doing what's right for the person that you're caring for, which I think is probably the higher level of it too.

0:3:37.120 --> 0:3:44.260

FR02

Because it does, you know, I mean, it does your decisions you make as a new paramedic impact somebody's life?

0:3:47.720 --> 0:3:48.170

Interviewer - GA

Right.

0:3:45.90 --> 0:3:48.750

FR02

You can make it better. You can make it worse than if you make it worse. It could be really bad.

0:3:49.970 --> 0:3:54.430

FR02

So that level of stress really, I mean it really weighs on you at the at the in the first part.

0:3:55.330 --> 0:4:1.280

FR02

About five years in, you feel a little bit better about it and then and then as you progress into like a supervisor role which.

0:4:3.480 --> 0:4:8.610

FR02

I really started getting into between 5 and 10 years of of being in a career and.

0:4:9.310 --> 0:4:11.10

FR02

You are responsible for.

0:4:11.980 --> 0:4:14.870

FR02

Three plus people, yourself, and what goes on.

0:4:15.690 --> 0:4:16.140

FR02

With.

0:4:16.870 --> 0:4:23.150

FR02

The person or the house or whatever else is going on the property, so it it compounds as you go along with it.

0:4:24.190 --> 0:4:25.800

FR02

Hopefully by then you found the.

0:4:26.490 --> 0:4:28.550

FR02

Pathway to manage a lot of that.

0:4:29.400 --> 0:4:30.60

FR02

Understand it.

0:4:30.680 --> 0:4:38.50

Interviewer - GA

Well, that that's like a perfect segue into my my next question, because I was gonna ask, you know, what would be helpful. So it sounds like as you.

0:4:38.960 --> 0:4:49.390

Interviewer - GA

As you progress through the system and as your role evolves and you take on more responsibility, there's additional stress and you said that after a certain point.

0:4:50.420 --> 0:4:59.560

Interviewer - GA

Umm. Or hopefully by that point that you've learned to manage that and what what has been helpful to you for managing that while on the job?

0:5:0.170 --> 0:5:6.470

FR02

Ah, it's been a it's been a roller coaster, I guess. I mean, there, there are times when I manage it well and there are times when I don't.

0:5:9.100 --> 0:5:12.780

FR02

A lot of it is understanding that the you have to disconnect from.

0:5:13.450 --> 0:5:16.160

FR02

From your job and fortunately I've had a lot of people to help me do that.

0:5:17.560 --> 0:5:21.320

FR02

Surrounding yourself with individuals that understand that already like the the.

0:5:22.70 --> 0:5:24.200

FR02

More experienced people in their career tend to have.

0:5:26.580 --> 0:5:30.20

FR02

Insight on those things, they pass it down from from one.

0:5:30.930 --> 0:5:31.970

FR02

Person to the next.

0:5:32.790 --> 0:5:33.260

FR02

Uh.

0:5:37.330 --> 0:5:41.470

FR02

Having the ability to discuss your your stressors and your frustrations with.

0:5:42.170 --> 0:5:55.500

FR02

With your career, with other people that have been through, it already is really dramatically helpful. One of the things that people, one of the most interesting things that happens to you as a first responder is people ask you what, what's the worst call you've seen?

0:5:56.920 --> 0:5:57.330

FR02

Uh.

0:5:58.490 --> 0:6:2.530

FR02

And it's an interesting question because you could tell people a lot of things.

0:6:3.560 --> 0:6:4.710

FR02

There are so many different.

0:6:6.560 --> 0:6:9.660

FR02

Traumatic or dramatic experiences that I've had.

0:6:11.20 --> 0:6:15.360

FR02

That I'm like. You can't. You can't even wrap your head around. What I'm I'm like.

0:6:17.70 --> 0:6:19.70

FR02

You can watch it in movie, but it's it's not the same.

0:6:19.810 --> 0:6:26.290

FR02

So that that's one of those things I think that really helps is having the ability to discuss those things with people in the like like environments.

0:6:26.970 --> 0:6:29.0

FR02

Umm. And then having.

0:6:29.840 --> 0:6:38.150

FR02

Having someone tell you that this shouldn't be like you have to find things outside of your career to do hobbies and other things that really are a benefit.

0:6:38.920 --> 0:6:44.510

FR02

To that, I picked up mountain biking, done some yoga recently. In the past few years I've done.

0:6:45.230 --> 0:6:52.0

FR02

Done that, some and those little things do tend to help, like the the meditations, the the other.

0:6:52.660 --> 0:6:57.300

FR02

Traditional stress management practices are they do help quite a bit.

0:6:58.420 --> 0:7:10.90

Interviewer - GA

So I noticed a lot of the things that you're sharing, at least as far as like the strategies that you use seem to be things. And correct me if I'm wrong, but seem to be things that occur off the job or off the clock.

0:7:10.700 --> 0:7:15.10

FR02

Yeah, it's very difficult. There are times when it's difficult to manage that on the clock.

0:7:15.910 --> 0:7:17.870

FR02

I know it worked kind of jump around questions here but.

0:7:19.460 --> 0:7:26.140

FR02

It is difficult to manage that sometimes on the clock. I work at 24 hour shift in that 24 hours I can be.

0:7:26.890 --> 0:7:28.320

FR02

I can take 15 calls.

0:7:29.90 --> 0:7:29.770

FR02

Or plus.

0:7:30.500 --> 0:7:31.240

FR02

Or I can take.

0:7:31.970 --> 0:7:32.460

FR02

None.

0:7:33.290 --> 0:7:40.10

FR02

It depends on the vehicle I'm on. It depends on what's going on. In my position, I'm a person that doesn't like to sit still very long.

0:7:40.730 --> 0:7:42.900

FR02

Uh, so there's always something for me to do.

0:7:44.460 --> 0:8:0.120

FR02

I would say that the the hard part is is consistency. Consistency at work, trying to manage those things. We have Wellness. We have a Wellness program where we have people come and do yoga with us at least once a month. We have some fitness exercise.

0:8:1.400 --> 0:8:2.350

FR02

Uh, that comes in.

0:8:3.40 --> 0:8:10.500

FR02

To help spur and encourage us to do those things, a lot of guys have time that they go out and hit the gym and.

0:8:11.470 --> 0:8:16.600

FR02

And do some physical activity, but it it varies depending on the vehicle you're on.

0:8:17.90 --> 0:8:21.850

FR02

Uh, a lot of it just ends up being like just having some downtime, just having like.

0:8:22.650 --> 0:8:24.50

FR02

15 or 20 minutes to.

0:8:25.480 --> 0:8:28.830

FR02

Have yourself some quiet time where you don't want to be around anybody else or.

0:8:30.520 --> 0:8:37.600

FR02

Taking the time to do some stretching and doing those little things does seem to work, but again, consistency I think is the hardest part.

0:8:38.880 --> 0:8:52.220

Interviewer - GA

Uh makes a lot of sense, so really you're talking about, you know, if if people ask you what was the worst call that you've taken, I'm not gonna ask you that. But I just wanted to know if you could give me a scenario where you did feel overwhelmed.

0:8:56.130 --> 0:8:58.370

FR02

Ohh gosh. I mean there's there's plenty to pull from.

0:8:59.750 --> 0:9:1.20

Interviewer - GA

Maybe the most recent one.

0:9:1.910 --> 0:9:2.770

FR02

Ohh.

0:9:6.600 --> 0:9:8.600

FR02

And that's the hard part. So I don't always think about these.



0:9:9.900 --> 0:9:19.180

FR02

And I knew this ahead of time. Ohh gosh, I want like like lately I've had a cumulative issue of of feeling overwhelmed. We had we recently had a.

0:9:20.250 --> 0:9:22.260

FR02

Uh, a deputy chief level person leave.

0:9:22.970 --> 0:9:28.810

FR02

And that person was a resource of mine for a lot of important equipment, right? So.

0:9:35.430 --> 0:9:35.830

Interviewer - GA

Right.

0:9:30.410 --> 0:10:0.640

FR02

The ambulances don't go out and just hand band aids to everybody without having somebody restock that stuff, right? So it's important to make sure that there's a there's a pathway, there's a chain, there's an understanding of, alright. So these people have this, the and it needs to be a regular, continual basis. There's gonna be communication problem. So on my end where I'm at, that's where my biggest level of stress has come is like not knowing, not knowing what the path forward is gonna be, not understanding where and how the supply chain's gonna work. And and understanding those items. You know, early on in my career have been.

0:10:4.650 --> 0:10:7.960

FR02

Well I shouldn't say early on, not too long ago we were in an auto accident. Where?

0:10:8.620 --> 0:10:20.710

FR02

I mean, we had four patients and one of which had already already died and there were probably five companies there working to get these people out of this car.

0:10:21.360 --> 0:10:33.130

FR02

And it just it was a lot of management of resources and then keeping other people on task and and doing those other items where you know the stress level and the the the workload was significant and.

0:10:34.580 --> 0:10:45.10

FR02

I caught my I found out that I was getting really hyperfocused on this one particular task at the end and it took somebody that was standing back watching the whole event to be like hey, you alright?

0:10:45.780 --> 0:11:1.420

FR02

Time out. Can you slow down? We need. We need to reset. What do you think of that? Like, that's a fantastic idea. And that's, you know, just something as simple as that. Understanding that, you know, you gotta watch other people and understand when their stress level is going to go [up the roof]. You gotta reset it. You gotta hit the timeout button. You gotta say alright, you need to.

0:11:2.310 --> 0:11:4.210

FR02

You need to think about what we're doing. It could be very.

0:11:7.250 --> 0:11:11.270

FR02

Very interesting from the human human perspective because.

0:11:11.890 --> 0:11:17.430

Interviewer - GA

Yeah, it sounds like a lot of moving parts and a lot of things to to keep track of. And of course, the fear of the unknown.

0:11:19.490 --> 0:11:19.880

Interviewer - GA

So.

0:11:19.160 --> 0:11:20.870

FR02

See fear of the unknown drives a lot.

0:11:21.900 --> 0:11:24.170

Interviewer - GA

Yeah, I can. I can. I can relate.

0:11:25.440 --> 0:11:38.760

Interviewer - GA

So we've talked about kind of like the more of like the mental component of occupational stress. And I'm curious, you know, do you deal with you've been on, you've been a first responder for like, [ALMOST TWO DECADES]?

0:11:40.380 --> 0:11:44.970

Interviewer - GA

I know that it can be pretty demanding on the body. I'm curious if you deal with any type of chronic pain.

0:11:45.440 --> 0:11:47.430

FR02

Uh gosh, I do.

0:11:49.180 --> 0:11:55.900

FR02

I have a middle back pain and some shoulder pain. Part of that is because of a motorcycle accident that I was on in.

0:11:56.630 --> 0:12:2.340

FR02

Took part of the other part of it is just normal everyday work wear and tear.

0:12:3.850 --> 0:12:9.0

FR02

You know, I will never forget I was. It was a at my volunteer place working and doing some part time work there and.

0:12:11.160 --> 0:12:12.70

FR02

But I've since left there.

0:12:12.720 --> 0:12:22.840

FR02

Uh doing that and then I just I bent over something to to move a shop back and I just had pain shoot up my back, the same area and it's just one of those things you're like, oh, man, what the heck?

0:12:23.540 --> 0:12:33.330

FR02

But yeah, that's something I I myself deal with. I know that a lot of other people in my field deal with similar issues, back pain, joint pain.

0:12:34.220 --> 0:12:34.700

FR02

Uh.

0:12:35.520 --> 0:12:42.600

FR02

Because it is a physically demanding job, you know, putting a 30 plus pound air pack on your back and then not even anything else.

0:12:43.560 --> 0:12:44.680

FR02

Expected to go do.

0:12:45.220 --> 0:12:47.190

FR02

Uh, flexible movements?

0:12:48.390 --> 0:12:51.580

FR02

Move the heavy weights around, so it's pretty pretty dynamic.

0:12:52.580 --> 0:12:56.870

Interviewer - GA

How do you think that work related plate work related pain?

0:12:57.870 --> 0:13:2.650

Interviewer - GA

Uh contributes or does not contribute to like the overall stress of the job?

0:13:5.610 --> 0:13:13.810

FR02

Ohh, I think that I think that as you as you grow older in the the field it affects you more. I'd say a lot of the younger people don't.

0:13:14.620 --> 0:13:16.190

FR02

Tend to think about that early on.

0:13:16.880 --> 0:13:23.130

FR02

Uh, that's something that I know. I as an instructor and things kind of stressed to to new people. Is that like hey?

0:13:23.980 --> 0:13:30.980

FR02

You get to beat yourself up. I one of the other things I do with regular. I didn't think about is I have tinnitus ringing in my ears for.

0:13:31.750 --> 0:13:32.350

FR02

Constantly.

0:13:33.90 --> 0:13:33.740

FR02

Never ends.

0:13:34.530 --> 0:13:44.260

FR02

And it's from poor choices and other things. And that's, you know, that drives me baller bananas. Sometimes it's just like I sit here and it sounds like there's an electronic hum going on.

0:13:46.300 --> 0:13:51.710

FR02

Little things like that can really build up overtime and create that added stress level too, but.

0:13:53.420 --> 0:14:6.420

Interviewer - GA

Do you see any type of opportunities that work? I know you had mentioned that consistency is like the biggest barrier of finding that time because it depends on what truck you're on. But do you have you identified you know times or?

0:14:7.120 --> 0:14:11.610

Interviewer - GA

Situations during the day where that could be used to incorporate well-being.

0:14:13.710 --> 0:14:23.570

FR02

I think the for me, the biggest battle of saying, you know, I can take 10 minutes, 10 minutes is doable anywhere with anything, no matter how busy we are.

0:14:24.970 --> 0:14:29.220

FR02

You can find a way to take 10 minutes and do something to help you.

0:14:29.920 --> 0:14:30.930

FR02

Reset and.

0:14:31.740 --> 0:14:34.530

FR02

And do some of those actions and I think that's a.

0:14:35.490 --> 0:14:41.970

FR02

One of it's the hardest parts because you on a busy day you just feel like you're going and go. You just wanna sit down and do nothing but it.

0:14:42.830 --> 0:14:46.30

FR02

It's hard to to tell yourself like hey.

0:14:46.860 --> 0:14:49.130

FR02

I need to take this 10 minutes. This 10 minutes is mine.

0:14:50.60 --> 0:14:50.630

FR02

Let's do that.

0:14:53.450 --> 0:14:57.530

FR02

I would say as a supervisor, I try to recognize that and see that in some of our crews.

0:14:59.0 --> 0:15:7.430

FR02

You know trying to push that mentality like, alright, you're gonna stay out of service like you're not gonna take any runs for the next 15 minutes. Do something to just.

0:15:8.420 --> 0:15:9.10

FR02

Reset.

0:15:10.350 --> 0:15:11.250

FR02

And that's hard to do.

0:15:12.710 --> 0:15:15.300

FR02

Because nobody likes to miss doing their job or anything like that.

0:15:17.490 --> 0:15:19.320

Interviewer - GA

Do you think there's a stigma?

0:15:20.90 --> 0:15:21.840

Interviewer - GA

To taking that time.

0:15:22.180 --> 0:15:25.480

FR02

Ohh, absolutely there is. There's absolutely a stigma to.

0:15:26.570 --> 0:15:27.460

FR02

To.

0:15:28.420 --> 0:15:32.150

FR02

And it's some places it's worse than others. I I would think on a whole.

0:15:33.130 --> 0:15:34.740

FR02

We're getting a lot better about it.

0:15:35.510 --> 0:15:37.550

FR02

In our our field, trying to say hey.

0:15:38.580 --> 0:15:47.550

FR02

We need to take some time. We need to do these things, even though we're only here. You know, we're here for 24 hours, but there needs to be some sort of avenue to to slow that down.

0:15:48.880 --> 0:15:56.870

FR02

And it depends on who you are like. They're even, even though it's a pretty common thing that we talk about, there are definitely people who like "ohh, you need to take a break."

0:15:58.550 --> 0:15:59.470

FR02

It's not healthy.

0:16:2.240 --> 0:16:2.710

Interviewer - GA

What?

0:16:3.680 --> 0:16:5.930

Interviewer - GA

What do you think could be like a potential?

0:16:6.900 --> 0:16:11.450

Interviewer - GA

Solution into like reducing that barrier of taking time.

0:16:14.190 --> 0:16:19.920

FR02

I think a lot of it is education and studies to say, hey, you know what, this this 15 minutes.

0:16:20.650 --> 0:16:24.150

FR02

You know, if it's a 15 minute nap in the afternoon.

0:16:25.480 --> 0:16:30.0

FR02

Or whatever. Whatever movement, whatever other thing, it it really would be.

0:16:30.940 --> 0:16:33.590

FR02

To be beneficial. Education I think is the hardest part.

0:16:36.540 --> 0:16:41.60

FR02

A lot of the more seasoned people are starting to speak out on those things also.

0:16:43.480 --> 0:16:55.210

FR02

They're they're slowly starting to say. Yeah, you know what? This has negatively impacted not only me at work, but me at home and me and life in general. And I think that's the other portion of it that really gets the education is.

0:16:56.0 --> 0:17:4.20

FR02

Is that not doing these things will dramatically change your personal life and your home life if you don't take care of it then.

0:17:5.840 --> 0:17:8.230

Interviewer - GA

Yeah, that makes that makes a lot of sense. Do you?

0:17:9.110 --> 0:17:14.240

Interviewer - GA

Do you think so? You've mentioned uh time in like consistency and then?

0:17:15.590 --> 0:17:23.340

Interviewer - GA

The educational or like the stigma component, can you think of any other barriers that would exist that might prevent?

0:17:25.40 --> 0:17:26.130

FR02

I.

0:17:24.840 --> 0:17:26.430

Interviewer - GA

You know, bringing Wellness to the job.

0:17:26.890 --> 0:17:30.380

FR02

I think from an occupational standpoint, I think.

0:17:33.50 --> 0:17:38.500

FR02

I think that one of the things that we do terribly in government is recognized that employees need this kind of stuff.

0:17:39.220 --> 0:17:44.980

FR02

Uh, it's been slow. It's hard to it's hard to educate the public to say, hey, you know.

0:17:47.50 --> 0:17:59.670

FR02

We pay for these items for these guys for this reason. As public servants we have, you know, we have a duty to minimize extraneous extemporaneous spending on whatever, right.

0:18:2.70 --> 0:18:9.210

FR02

You know we're we're a few votes away from not having enough funding to keep the trucks rolling out the door or some places.

0:18:10.170 --> 0:18:13.140

FR02

Have trouble just keeping people staffed in general?

0:18:14.590 --> 0:18:27.190

FR02

So I think that's one of the hard parts, at least in the public sector of things is is that you were dealing with the opinions of the masses when it comes to how much funding and how much other things. So education of the general populace.



0:18:27.850 --> 0:18:30.560

FR02

For some of these items can be helpful at times.

0:18:32.420 --> 0:18:36.770

FR02

Again, they're always. We're always under money crunch and Wellness programs are gonna be the first thing to cut.

0:18:37.630 --> 0:18:41.270

FR02

If if funding is fortunate where I work, we don't have that issue. But.

0:18:42.990 --> 0:18:45.490

FR02

When it comes to that kind of stuff, it's a major barrier.

0:18:48.430 --> 0:18:54.370

Interviewer - GA

And and what are your thoughts about incorporating, like mindfulness into your daily work life?

0:18:56.690 --> 0:19:12.170

FR02

I say fortunately have been my wife, went through a yoga instructor class so she threw constantly, reminding me of do that and then we've had again. We've had these Wellness initiatives that included yoga and some of those things, which I have found very. I've been very receptive to it. Not everybody is.

0:19:15.200 --> 0:19:18.790

FR02

So understanding that is a big importance to me.

0:19:20.240 --> 0:19:25.130

FR02

And trying to do it is important to me. The hard part is that I don't always incorporated in my day.

0:19:27.30 --> 0:19:29.940

FR02

I slip into that mindset like I got this to do. I got that to do or I.

0:19:35.710 --> 0:19:36.80

Interviewer - GA

Right.

0:19:30.660 --> 0:19:37.170

FR02

Or my my phone, in my hand, and zombie out on whatever Rando app I have for that 20 minutes. Which is it?

0:19:38.690 --> 0:19:49.70

FR02

It's not the worst, but it's not the best, you know, like it escapes, but it's not. It's not managing that stress. It's sitting in a chair like this, so it's adding to all the extra pain and discomfort moving else.

0:19:51.40 --> 0:19:55.230

Interviewer - GA

Do you think attending like if you were to attend one session a week?

0:19:55.940 --> 0:19:58.780

Interviewer - GA

You know for eight weeks and it was on the job.

0:19:59.500 --> 0:20:3.950

Interviewer - GA

Do you think that would be something that's feasible, a mindfulness session?

0:20:5.570 --> 0:20:8.920

FR02

I think location makes a big difference. I think that.

0:20:9.780 --> 0:20:13.490

FR02

When it comes to a like.

0:20:15.710 --> 0:20:27.220

FR02

Daily staffing and other things that creates some challenges I would attend, I would try to attend something like that. I would be in favor of something like that. I know multiple other people would be interested with that as well.

0:20:28.30 --> 0:20:28.540

FR02

Uh.

0:20:29.750 --> 0:20:36.220

FR02

Again, it's the logistical standpoint that becomes the challenge for us. But yeah, I think we want something like that would be great if you're like, hey, you're gonna.

0:20:36.980 --> 0:20:42.710

FR02

You're going to do this. This is really good for you, and some people won't be receptive. I think that's the other hard part. It's just not gonna get 100 percent by it.

0:20:43.680 --> 0:20:44.360

FR02

Will never happen.

0:20:45.10 --> 0:20:45.410

Interviewer - GA

Right.

0:20:46.900 --> 0:20:52.710

Interviewer - GA

And and have you ever used like a a stress reduction app?

0:20:53.820 --> 0:21:3.700

FR02

I have not. I've heard of people doing that and it's been recommended to me by by numerous people. I have not personally done that, but I could see it's benefits.

0:21:5.230 --> 0:21:10.70

Interviewer - GA

And do you think that's something that could be used during work without interfering with the job?

0:21:9.70 --> 0:21:14.600

FR02

Yeah, yeah, there would be. There would be no issue. I mean I I guess the hardest part would that would the interruption.

0:21:15.710 --> 0:21:27.20

FR02

Right. Like it seems as though as soon as you wanna do something like, oh, we gotta go put the smoke detector in or something like that. Right? Like Ohh there's, you know, somebody's there's ducks in the sewer grate. We gotta pull out.

0:21:29.450 --> 0:21:34.640

FR02

Those are the items that it becomes. Those are the times when that becomes challenging cause you to get disheartened.

0:21:35.490 --> 0:21:43.190

FR02

Disheartened, or disenfranchised, with making the attempt if it continues to get interrupted. But I do think that it would be some sort of.

0:21:44.500 --> 0:21:51.870

FR02

Multiple time a day like hey reminder, it's time to do some sort of mindfulness thing that they like. I think that would benefit me.

0:21:53.380 --> 0:21:58.290

FR02

I uh, I'm terrible about just sitting down doing. I thought we had something that was poking me the whole time that, like, snap.

0:21:59.450 --> 0:22:0.360

Interviewer - GA

Right.

0:21:59.450 --> 0:22:0.940

FR02

Hey, do some stretching.

0:22:2.160 --> 0:22:7.30

Interviewer - GA

Is, is there anything specific that would make you want to use an app for mindfulness?

0:22:13.200 --> 0:22:14.560

FR02

I I don't know.

0:22:15.290 --> 0:22:17.70

FR02

That's a good question. If there's any.

0:22:19.140 --> 0:22:26.930

Interviewer - GA

Or would there? Would there need to be anything present on a mindfulness app that would entice you to use it or make it more attractive to you?

0:22:36.500 --> 0:22:37.780

FR02

I the gosh.

0:22:38.900 --> 0:22:41.420

FR02

I don't really know. I mean, it has to be.

0:22:42.220 --> 0:22:46.300

FR02

One of the things we want the guys I work with is simple and repeatable like it needs to be.

0:22:47.580 --> 0:22:52.710

FR02

A non complex thing, but it's it's repeatable every day and or or every shift.

0:22:54.870 --> 0:22:56.520

FR02

And doesn't necessarily take.

0:22:57.400 --> 0:23:5.150

FR02

A long period of time like those things are important to me when it comes to the stuff I do at work. Uh, you could walk in there any Firehouse and see people sitting in recliners every day.

0:23:8.970 --> 0:23:11.960

FR02

So the time is relative to where you're at in the.

0:23:13.230 --> 0:23:15.820

FR02

The hierarchy of things.

0:23:17.400 --> 0:23:23.860

FR02

Ah, gosh, things that I would incorporate. I mean a a video or an audio walkthrough would be nice. Like I think that.

0:23:25.60 --> 0:23:27.50

FR02

You know, having having like some.

0:23:29.250 --> 0:23:34.440

FR02

History with some yoga and stuff like that. Just a walk through. close your eyes, take away some of the.

0:23:36.420 --> 0:23:39.160

FR02

Take away some of the stimulants.

0:23:39.990 --> 0:23:50.760

FR02

That you have every day. You know your phone is a stimulus just sitting there watching a video might not be the best, but for some others it might be better. For me it wouldn't like me. It would have to be just like, hey, sit down and listen to this.

0:23:51.630 --> 0:23:54.520

FR02

Walk through trying to get your brain to calm down and.

0:23:55.470 --> 0:23:56.310

FR02

Reset that kind of stuff.

0:23:57.440 --> 0:23:59.130

Interviewer - GA

So I know you had talked about.

0:23:59.940 --> 0:24:8.880

Interviewer - GA

You know it's you might not be able to reach 100% of your coworkers who might be interested in mindfulness. I'm curious, do you think?

0:24:10.20 --> 0:24:12.870

Interviewer - GA

Coworkers of yours, those who would be interested.

0:24:14.290 --> 0:24:16.900

Interviewer - GA

Would be interested in using an app for mindfulness.

0:24:18.20 --> 0:24:20.50

FR02

I think so. I think it helps.

0:24:22.350 --> 0:24:25.380

FR02

I think it's nice because it's a an on an individual basis.

0:24:26.260 --> 0:24:29.110

FR02

Like if those that want to use it will use it.

0:24:30.270 --> 0:24:33.890

FR02

If they have a space to use it as well, that's one of the other challenges that we run into.

0:24:34.720 --> 0:24:37.650

FR02

Spaces at a limit premium where I'm at.

0:24:38.350 --> 0:24:47.400

FR02

No, we still have large open I say open bump rooms with a large room with bumps in it with curtains dividing everyone. So there's limited. I have an office, so it would be a problem.

0:24:50.900 --> 0:24:54.210

FR02

Yeah, I think they would as long as they understood it and.

0:24:55.420 --> 0:25:1.560

FR02

We're giving to it. I'm sure that cost is a major factor for some of them as well. So if I found major benefited to it, I'd be like.

0:25:2.610 --> 0:25:4.60

FR02

I'll pay for that service, but.

0:25:5.550 --> 0:25:10.750

Interviewer - GA

OK. And what barriers do you think would exist for using like an app during the day?

0:25:12.270 --> 0:25:14.510

FR02

So again, like I said, space space is one of them.

0:25:16.80 --> 0:25:16.860

FR02

Interruptions.

0:25:18.230 --> 0:25:20.130

FR02

During the day would be a challenge.

0:25:21.40 --> 0:25:21.770

FR02

Uh.

0:25:23.950 --> 0:25:25.580

FR02

Perception on the.

0:25:26.670 --> 0:25:27.150

FR02

On the.

0:25:27.840 --> 0:25:38.100

FR02

The workspace end of it, you know, supervisory supervisor things, thinking you're not really doing it but the education portion of it says, hey, this is this is found to be very important for these guys.

0:25:43.420 --> 0:25:44.570

FR02

I think those are the biggest ones.

0:25:45.560 --> 0:26:1.860

Interviewer - GA

OK. And what information would you want to be? What would be helpful to be in the app? I know you had said like guidance a video of sort or some type of audio guiding you through, so you don't have to think about it necessarily, just kind of follow the guide, is there anything else?

0:26:3.180 --> 0:26:3.860

FR02

Ohh.

0:26:5.30 --> 0:26:8.420

FR02

When I. It sounds funny, but a variety of voices so.

0:26:8.130 --> 0:26:9.500

Interviewer - GA

OK, that's interesting.

0:26:9.260 --> 0:26:24.970

FR02

Uh uh, we've had. We've had people that are like, I I can't listen to that person talk like it doesn't. It doesn't help me. And there are other people that are like, ohh man, that person's voice it's just soothing and relaxing and.

0:26:25.690 --> 0:26:35.370

FR02

Uh, really? Chill. So that's one of those in in my wife has some similar experiences with voices, but yeah, that I would say that would be one of the like, odd ones that I'm like, yeah, I have a different.

0:26:36.500 --> 0:26:39.540

FR02

Few selections of voices because like, if you're going to do something like that, cause it's.

0:26:40.730 --> 0:26:42.730

FR02

Different people respond differently to.

0:26:44.590 --> 0:26:45.240

FR02

Those items.

0:26:46.920 --> 0:26:54.770

FR02

Ohh gosh and then I I guess having the ability to have a like a physical object like a more physically intensive option and a.

0:26:56.30 --> 0:26:59.10

FR02

More mindfulness non movement?

0:27:0.10 --> 0:27:0.460

FR02

As well.

0:27:1.460 --> 0:27:11.770

Interviewer - GA

OK, so uh, so voices. So that of different voices so that people could find, you know, what they resonated with and then options.

0:27:13.460 --> 0:27:24.780

Interviewer - GA

If they wanted to pursue something more physically based or something more mentally based, I'm curious if you've ever I'm. I'm deviating from the script here, but I'm curious if you've thought about like.



0:27:25.780 --> 0:27:27.730

Interviewer - GA

You know, if you could have anything you want.

0:27:29.520 --> 0:27:31.400

Interviewer - GA

What you want feedback from the app?

0:27:33.710 --> 0:27:33.860

Interviewer - GA

Like.

0:27:33.590 --> 0:27:41.660

FR02

Yeah, I think so. Yeah. Just say, hey, you know what, you you've been successful, I guess this stupid Apple watches or the the screen time and stuff like that like.

0:27:42.480 --> 0:27:46.270

FR02

And yet those feedbacks, once a week and you're like, oh man, I'm really like not.

0:27:46.940 --> 0:27:48.570

FR02

Present or I am not.

0:27:49.660 --> 0:27:50.320

FR02

And.

0:27:51.100 --> 0:27:56.380

FR02

I'm not questioning like I'm not moving around very much today like that kind of stuff does does I think help.

0:27:57.890 --> 0:27:58.840

FR02

I think there's a.

0:28:1.280 --> 0:28:4.80

FR02

There's a level as to how much added stress does that provide?

0:28:5.270 --> 0:28:7.750

FR02

Not doing that? Does that add a level of stress, but.

0:28:8.710 --> 0:28:9.200

Interviewer - GA

OK.

0:28:10.600 --> 0:28:11.300

Interviewer - GA

Do you think?

0:28:11.210 --> 0:28:15.0

FR02

As I say, it's a balance like nothing, nothing in life is free. So.

0:28:16.150 --> 0:28:17.870

FR02

Give up something to get something else.

0:28:18.790 --> 0:28:21.100

Interviewer - GA

Do you? Haven't you said you have an Apple Watch?

0:28:21.670 --> 0:28:22.450

FR02

Yeah.

0:28:22.960 --> 0:28:23.380

Interviewer - GA

If.

0:28:24.230 --> 0:28:42.60

Interviewer - GA

If that was synced, I'm again shooting off the cuff here, but if that was synced to the app and you could, say, watch your heart rate decrease while you're doing the mindfulness, do you think that would motivate you or give you information that would tell you if, like, this is making a difference?

0:28:45.890 --> 0:28:46.230

Interviewer - GA

OK.

0:28:42.890 --> 0:28:55.530

FR02

I think like a report afterward would be good like to say, hey you, you've completed this, yes, this this worked for you. This this brought your heart rate down it you had the noticeable change here or.

0:28:56.780 --> 0:28:58.400

FR02

Like, I think that would be helpful. Yeah.

0:29:0.120 --> 0:29:2.210

Interviewer - GA

OK. And then in the videos?

0:29:2.900 --> 0:29:8.70

Interviewer - GA

You know, let's say you elect to do a video that day. You know who should be present in the videos.

0:29:9.190 --> 0:29:10.900

Interviewer - GA

Is it? Should it be?

0:29:12.230 --> 0:29:14.100

Interviewer - GA

Well, I'll leave it at that. I won't prompt you.

0:29:25.300 --> 0:29:25.610

Interviewer - GA

OK.

0:29:19.640 --> 0:29:25.890

FR02

For me, it's very like I I'm. I'm willing to listen to a lot of different people. Like I don't need.

0:29:26.900 --> 0:29:29.470

FR02

I don't need some superstar muscle head to do it.

0:29:31.550 --> 0:29:37.740

FR02

I'm not always in the majority of the people I work with, like sometimes the people I work with when I have somebody that's.

0:29:38.770 --> 0:29:39.470

FR02

Similar to them.

0:29:40.650 --> 0:29:41.20

Interviewer - GA

OK.

0:29:40.330 --> 0:29:50.280

FR02

When it comes to fitness standards and those other items to say hey, alright, you know, it's like it's like body. You know you listen to bodybuilders because you wanna be a bodybuilder. You don't.

0:29:51.900 --> 0:29:54.820

FR02

But the mindfulness portion of it, like you wanna make sure that.

0:29:56.360 --> 0:29:57.870

FR02

Again, I think that there's.

0:29:59.150 --> 0:30:3.380

FR02

There's delivery methods that work well for some people versus others in.

0:30:4.140 --> 0:30:6.240

FR02

You know, an audio mindfulness.

0:30:7.10 --> 0:30:17.160

FR02

Is not going to be the same as the video physical aspect of. If you do a physical mindfulness app aspect or something like that, right? Like if you movements could be different than.

0:30:18.330 --> 0:30:19.670

FR02

It doesn't answer your question very well.

0:30:20.350 --> 0:30:20.800

FR02

Uh.

0:30:23.120 --> 0:30:29.520

Interviewer - GA

No, I I I I don't think it does a I think you're answering it. I I'm curious, you know you said somebody who is like.

0:30:30.250 --> 0:30:34.440

Interviewer - GA

Them. So if they were, you know, potentially like another first responder.

0:30:36.80 --> 0:30:37.740

Interviewer - GA

When you envision that.

0:30:39.230 --> 0:30:52.920

Interviewer - GA

If if they're watching a video, you know, do you expect or do you think of like somebody in uniform or does somebody come out and say, you know, they introduce themselves, they say who they are and that they're first responder and they identify themselves that way.

0:30:52.880 --> 0:30:57.840

FR02

I think I think it's more the identification. I don't think a uniform necessarily is part of that.

0:31:1.520 --> 0:31:2.800

FR02

But even just the.

0:31:3.780 --> 0:31:6.390

FR02

The language and the the.

0:31:8.690 --> 0:31:10.980

FR02

The jargon, if you will, of.

0:31:11.970 --> 0:31:14.50

FR02

Different aspects of our job would be.

0:31:14.960 --> 0:31:16.50

FR02

More relatable.

0:31:16.630 --> 0:31:16.980

Interviewer - GA

OK.

0:31:19.320 --> 0:31:19.690

Interviewer - GA

Deep.

0:31:19.110 --> 0:31:20.660

FR02

When it comes to those kind of things, yeah.

0:31:21.330 --> 0:31:22.840

Interviewer - GA

OK. Do you think?

0:31:24.100 --> 0:31:28.170

Interviewer - GA

Of your coworkers would be more receptive to.

0:31:29.580 --> 0:31:34.510

Interviewer - GA

Receiving that education or that that video or that mindfulness? UM.

0:31:35.370 --> 0:31:40.50

Interviewer - GA

From a first responder or from somebody who's like a a medical expert.

0:31:44.410 --> 0:31:46.310

FR02

I think both are.

0:31:47.160 --> 0:31:47.840

FR02

Acceptable.

0:31:48.590 --> 0:31:48.920

Interviewer - GA

OK.

0:31:48.930 --> 0:31:53.180

FR02

If you if you had, even if you had both of them like a a coordination between the two.

0:31:54.510 --> 0:31:58.150

FR02

I think that would be very well received because most people.

0:31:59.670 --> 0:32:3.240

FR02

We get a lot of information presented to us, especially from the medical side of things.

0:32:4.750 --> 0:32:7.290

FR02

So there's a lot of trust in that aspect of.

0:32:9.140 --> 0:32:16.730

FR02

Of our job when it comes to medical researching and studies or you know, sciences behind things, I don't think that there's any issue with that.

0:32:17.490 --> 0:32:21.710

FR02

I think when you add someone that is experienced or been a part of programs like that, that says.

0:32:22.370 --> 0:32:23.720

FR02

Yeah, this works.

0:32:24.900 --> 0:32:26.290

FR02

This is the time you can do this.

0:32:27.80 --> 0:32:29.530

FR02

Take the time to do it because it's dramatically helpful.

0:32:30.350 --> 0:32:33.690

FR02

Uh, I think that just adds that extra layer of.

0:32:35.720 --> 0:32:36.330

FR02

Of trust.

0:32:37.790 --> 0:32:38.590

FR02

Or acceptance.

0:32:40.70 --> 0:32:40.460

Interviewer - GA

OK.

0:32:43.370 --> 0:32:51.780

Interviewer - GA

So we've, we've hit like the core questions, but is there anything that we've talked about that maybe you wanted to share or maybe you're thinking of now?

0:32:52.720 --> 0:32:54.150

Interviewer - GA

That you'd want to go back over.

0:32:57.750 --> 0:33:3.630

FR02

I think a lot of it I try to answer from my perspective, I'm pretty open book when it comes to.

0:33:4.320 --> 0:33:8.30

FR02

Wanting to try different things and do these different aspects, I think that I'm.

0:33:9.250 --> 0:33:9.760

FR02

Uh.

0:33:10.670 --> 0:33:14.880

FR02

One of the things that I notice a lot in the Firehouse is it that we'll start off on a program pretty strong.

0:33:15.700 --> 0:33:16.450

FR02

And then.

0:33:17.340 --> 0:33:31.730

FR02

Initially will be, you know 80% 80% by and 80% participation and then as time goes on and you miss or something else happens, you're dropping down in the 20-30%. So it seems to be it's very cyclical.

0:33:32.520 --> 0:33:36.690

FR02

And and programs and trying to get things moving and refreshed.

0:33:37.350 --> 0:33:40.490

FR02

I think that's one of the other things you have to do, a regular check in.

0:33:41.390 --> 0:33:42.340

FR02

These people that are.

0:33:43.40 --> 0:33:46.170

FR02

Part of programs are doing these Wellness initiatives.

0:33:48.460 --> 0:33:54.480

FR02

To remind them why they're doing it and to to build that back up, I think it's kind of like a human nature thing, but.

0:33:55.360 --> 0:34:10.850

FR02

Uh, for me, that's that's one of the hardest parts is watching that, you know, watch watching the participation drop off and knowing everybody knows, like, this isn't like new tech, new science and new information. It it's trying to maintain that level of.

0:34:12.750 --> 0:34:13.360

FR02

Of.

0:34:14.100 --> 0:34:14.890

FR02

Encouragement.

0:34:16.100 --> 0:34:16.870

FR02

To maintain it.

0:34:22.930 --> 0:34:23.600

FR02

And then I think.

0:34:22.700 --> 0:34:24.630

Interviewer - GA

To maintain like the consistency or.

0:34:24.350 --> 0:34:28.280

FR02

Yeah. Maintain consistency. Yeah, maintaining consistency is the hardest part.



0:34:30.490 --> 0:34:30.870

FR02

Uh.

0:34:30.110 --> 0:34:33.520

Interviewer - GA

Do you think that drop off is related to anything in particular?

0:34:36.580 --> 0:34:40.510

FR02

Uh, at work stuff is gonna be interruptions.

0:34:41.200 --> 0:34:54.470

FR02

Right, like interruptions in your day, interruptions in trying to do the event. And then what happened? For some weird reason, the way that the way it happens where I work is that today we will take two runs.

0:34:55.850 --> 0:35:0.410

FR02

The next day we will be busy the entire shift like we just won't stop running.

0:35:1.450 --> 0:35:2.930

FR02

And then you'll go 2 weeks.

0:35:3.740 --> 0:35:7.670

FR02

Nothing. And then you'll have 3 shifts of just like boom, boom, boom, boom all day long.

0:35:8.360 --> 0:35:13.460

FR02

And it could. It doesn't even have to be calls. It could be service, service, things. It could be trainings, it could be.

0:35:14.150 --> 0:35:22.250

FR02

All these other items that we have to get done, like the they're part of our standards and I think that's where at least in my experiences.

0:35:23.10 --> 0:35:35.810

FR02

It becomes difficult if there are things right at the end of shift at the beginning of shift. Sometimes that could be very helpful. You know, even if it's like a 10 minutes before your shift starts or within 1/2 hour before your shift starts, it really.

0:35:37.720 --> 0:35:40.750

FR02

I think that's a a good time frame to make things happen.

0:35:41.400 --> 0:35:41.770

Interviewer - GA

OK.

0:35:46.210 --> 0:35:46.810

FR02

Again.

0:35:45.970 --> 0:35:53.460

Interviewer - GA

That's really helpful. As far as like a sweet spot of, you know, where you could get the best compliance and consistency over time.

0:35:53.570 --> 0:36:5.940

FR02

Yeah, immediately before and after shift is probably the most. I think the most reliable places that you can get anything done. Now some people have, you know, cause some people have children, they have to go home and take care of. Some people have.

0:36:7.410 --> 0:36:9.310

FR02

Other life things they have to take care of.

0:36:10.540 --> 0:36:12.620

FR02

Most people show up to work half an hour early.

0:36:15.770 --> 0:36:26.340

FR02

Me. I'm there half hour past my shift change. It just depends on what's going on and then compensation for that kind of stuff can also be of benefit and encouragement. But I don't know that it would be driving.

0:36:27.560 --> 0:36:28.50

FR02

That.

0:36:29.20 --> 0:36:30.210

FR02

Idea necessarily.

0:36:31.780 --> 0:36:35.950

Interviewer - GA

Do you think an an app based reminder?

0:36:36.640 --> 0:36:46.720

Interviewer - GA

Would be helpful, like within a mindfulness app, just nudging them, people saying, hey, you know, you haven't engaged with this for a couple of days.

0:36:47.70 --> 0:36:56.270

FR02

Absolutely. Like I I think that's very important like it works on most everything else, right? Like I respond to emails because I'm reminded, hey, you didn't reply to this e-mail and three days.

0:36:57.0 --> 0:37:3.370

FR02

Or, uh, with the quantity of information that's thrown at us every single day.

0:37:4.560 --> 0:37:10.310

FR02

And with so many families having 15 or 20 different activities they're doing in a given year.

0:37:12.450 --> 0:37:21.770

FR02

Simple reminders like that to take 10 minutes or 15 minutes or whatever it is. It is probably the biggest help, like just that simple reminder.

0:37:23.450 --> 0:37:24.840

Interviewer - GA

OK and.

0:37:24.210 --> 0:37:36.810

FR02

And that's what I I struggle with that all the time. I'm like, you know what? It's it would take you 15 minutes. Why are you wasting 30 on this, Tik T.O.K or whatever the hell app you're on today. Like you could have taken 10 minutes and major like better.

0:37:37.970 --> 0:37:38.950

FR02

It's all it would have taken.

0:37:39.560 --> 0:37:42.470

Interviewer - GA

Right. And then you beat yourself up, right? Yeah.

0:37:43.530 --> 0:37:45.760

Interviewer - GA

And then you feel more stressed? Yep.

0:37:41.410 --> 0:37:47.30

FR02

Yeah. Then that. That afterward. You're like, oh, why didn't I do this? Yeah, exactly. It's a cyclical problem.

0:37:48.470 --> 0:37:50.310

Interviewer - GA

Yeah, it's. It's hard to change behavior.

0:37:51.260 --> 0:37:56.810

Interviewer - GA

Especially when you're, you know, in the habit for so long. Uh, just used to doing things a certain way.

0:37:57.170 --> 0:38:3.820

FR02

So you you say that and I guess that would be the other thing that would be interesting and maybe something to add to.

0:38:4.550 --> 0:38:5.160

FR02

Umm.

0:38:6.220 --> 0:38:10.210

FR02

The whole plan is, is the initial firefighter paramedic training.

0:38:13.20 --> 0:38:19.30

FR02

Is a perfect place to start that like like we kind of have a joke that that culture changes with retirement.

0:38:20.560 --> 0:38:22.400

FR02

We can change the culture of the.

0:38:24.60 --> 0:38:29.30

FR02

Of our field by changing the mentality of every single person that comes in.

0:38:29.950 --> 0:38:31.960

FR02

So getting that educational portion.

0:38:32.260 --> 0:38:35.480

FR02

Uh pushed heavily at the front end of your career.

0:38:36.770 --> 0:38:42.370

FR02

will create those habits a lot easier than trying to change the, you know, 30 year firefighter. It's like.

0:38:43.440 --> 0:38:45.280

FR02

I'm already stressed out. I don't know how to manage this.

0:38:46.120 --> 0:38:48.500

Interviewer - GA

Right. Yes. So so working further upstream.

0:38:49.90 --> 0:38:56.340

FR02

Yeah. Yeah, it's a big and and we've worked towards that with things like stress management and cancer recognition and.

0:38:57.10 --> 0:39:1.180

FR02

Some of the other things that pop up with our our our like we had a class.

0:39:3.100 --> 0:39:10.620

FR02

That started it in like January, something that I was teaching and I went through the whole cancer lecture and somebody left. After that. They were like, yeah, that.

0:39:11.360 --> 0:39:13.0

FR02

No thanks. I don't wanna be a part of that.

0:39:14.690 --> 0:39:16.580

FR02

So those discussions have actually.

0:39:17.280 --> 0:39:18.740

FR02

I would say they've helped spur.

0:39:19.950 --> 0:39:30.240

FR02

Thoughts on people that maybe shouldn't do this job to begin with because they can't handle that level of stress and some of those other issues that pop up and help them lead a better life themselves by not doing it to begin with.

0:39:32.750 --> 0:39:37.230

Interviewer - GA

That's really interesting insight. I appreciate that. Is there anything else that?

0:39:38.460 --> 0:39:42.230

Interviewer - GA

You think we should know about designing like a work based?

0:39:43.210 --> 0:39:56.200

Interviewer - GA

Reduce Stress reduction program we talked about like finding the right time consistency, having some like flexibility within the program so that it could suit the users a little bit more. Anything else you could think of?

0:39:56.540 --> 0:40:10.710

FR02

And the only other thing I would say would be resource resources like the availability of resources, there

are so many resources out there for people. If they know where to look and and not having a direction to go in is probably the most challenging portion.

0:40:12.780 --> 0:40:16.680

FR02

So if someone said, you know, hey, you know, this Wellness app isn't working for me.

0:40:17.440 --> 0:40:19.490

FR02

Maybe there are some alternatives for you.

0:40:21.640 --> 0:40:28.680

FR02

What those are is, again, there's there's plenty of resources out there. It's just a matter of identifying them and collecting them and and.

0:40:29.610 --> 0:40:31.870

FR02

Making it easy for someone to find it.

0:40:33.360 --> 0:40:33.730

Interviewer - GA

OK.

0:40:35.320 --> 0:40:35.870

Interviewer - GA

Awesome.

0:40:35.270 --> 0:40:41.600

FR02

And by and by that I mean I don't necessarily mean like the the mindfulness stuff. I mean, the next level kind of things, right, like.

0:40:42.880 --> 0:40:45.10

FR02

If you do get to these levels, this is what you need to do.

0:40:46.980 --> 0:40:51.710

Interviewer - GA

So almost like a a road map of sorts that somebody could follow.

0:40:52.920 --> 0:40:54.730

Interviewer - GA

If things needed to like escalate.

0:40:55.190 --> 0:40:55.630

FR02

Yes.

0:41:2.120 --> 0:41:2.830

FR02

Absolutely.

0:40:56.460 --> 0:41:6.330

Interviewer - GA

They cause like we we have that problem. I feel like that's a a societal problem with like we have all these resources everywhere, but it's like you don't know who to ask, don't know where to find them.

0:41:7.50 --> 0:41:10.310

FR02

And and some of them are very difficult to get right like so.

0:41:11.700 --> 0:41:13.790

FR02

But it it's it's regional, it's.

0:41:14.510 --> 0:41:19.160

FR02

Umm, you know, we have our there's a retreat every like two or three times a year.

0:41:20.760 --> 0:41:35.50

FR02

Here in town for first responders for stress management and resource identification. And it's it's a 20, it's a two day fully paid for retreat at a hotel. We talked to people and figure it all out but.

0:41:36.90 --> 0:41:36.910

FR02

It's a.

0:41:38.340 --> 0:41:42.170

FR02

Well, that's the thing you gotta know about it. You gotta know what it is. You gotta you gotta be a part of it.

0:41:42.760 --> 0:41:43.190

Interviewer - GA

Right.

0:41:43.980 --> 0:41:46.60

FR02

So that's one of those deals. You're like, oh, that's interesting.

0:41:47.530 --> 0:41:47.750

FR02

But.

0:41:47.290 --> 0:41:50.810

Interviewer - GA

Do you think that information would be helpful to include in the app?

0:41:51.630 --> 0:42:4.0

FR02

Yeah, well, absolutely. Like, if you had, if you had in mind mindfulness retreats and somebody's other things that were like minded with my like minded individuals, I know that it's not it's first responders bridges I don't if you're familiar with that program at all.

0:42:3.720 --> 0:42:4.290

Interviewer - GA

I'm not.

0:42:6.500 --> 0:42:14.210

FR02

But that's one of those events, you know, that's one of those three things that it's designed to help with stress management. It's designed to help with those other items.

0:42:17.90 --> 0:42:26.820

FR02

And knowing that resource is out there, I mean there are plenty of plenty of people that have no idea how you're doing a you're doing a whole thing on 1st Responder Wellness and this is essential thing you know, I do about it.

0:42:27.560 --> 0:42:30.900

FR02

To something like that is is helpful. It's it's beneficial for these segments.

0:42:32.370 --> 0:42:41.880

Interviewer - GA

What are your thoughts then on including, you know, we had talked about a road map of, you know, things needed to escalate. What are your thoughts on including something like that in the app?

0:42:42.620 --> 0:42:48.80

FR02

Yeah, I think that's again, I think that's phenomenal that suicides and and all that are significant.

0:42:49.300 --> 0:42:55.110

FR02

Uh. A significant portion of the line of duty that like more people die, more firefighters died by suicide.

0:42:55.930 --> 0:42:58.650

FR02

Then by on duty, like fighting fires.

0:43:1.130 --> 0:43:2.260

FR02

It doesn't get talked about a ton.



0:43:4.640 --> 0:43:18.810

FR02

So those are those are other things that you know if the resource is there that somebody's, it's easy for them to be like alright, maybe I do need to, you know questionnaires or somebody other things I don't know. I don't know if that's just to be like hey you might wanna consider.

0:43:21.170 --> 0:43:25.410

FR02

Just say, hey, you're thinking about any of these things. We have these resources. These are resources that you can contact.

0:43:26.200 --> 0:43:27.130

FR02

It's an open thing.

0:43:29.100 --> 0:43:32.100

Interviewer - GA

That's that is great information. Is there anything else?

0:43:33.510 --> 0:43:34.770

Interviewer - GA

That you think we should know.

0:43:36.370 --> 0:43:38.600

FR02

Ohh gosh just the.

0:43:40.480 --> 0:43:42.790

FR02

And just like anywhere else, we are a.

0:43:43.480 --> 0:43:46.490

FR02

Microcosm of the population. So you have the people that are.

0:43:47.380 --> 0:43:50.410

FR02

Very strongly for and against things.

0:43:52.460 --> 0:43:59.110

FR02

Most of them are pretty open when you get them in on an individual basis, but you can get when you get our groups into group mindsets. Sometimes it can be.

0:44:0.0 --> 0:44:4.380

FR02

Uh, challenging at the least change opinions and to.

0:44:5.570 --> 0:44:6.720

FR02

Establish a normalcies.

0:44:8.820 --> 0:44:17.70

Interviewer - GA

Well, thank you so much for your time and your feedback. This is really useful information and I'm excited to to take it back to the team.

0:44:18.940 --> 0:44:23.800

FR02

I hope I hopefully hopefully my ramblings have have provided some help but.